European gas prices climbed above €100/MWh as mounting supply concerns rattle the market ahead of the 2026/27 winter



Warren Patterson

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following the US midterm elections next week. Reportedly, QatarEnergy has extended its force majeure for several buyers until the end of the year. It means significant LNG supply disruptions are creeping deeper into the heating season. In addition, several unplanned outages in Norway will add to supply concerns.

Furthermore, forecasts show colder-than-usual weather in Northwest Europe from next week, pushing heating demand higher. This will likely start leading to more sustained drawdowns in storage. EU gas storage is just shy of 75% full. While we've had a

couple of days of draws in October, winter storage draws have yet to fully get underway.

The key question is whether these higher prices will destroy demand. In power markets, we're already deep into the gas-to-coal switching range. Industrial demand also shows signs of softening. Chemical company Yara recently reported curtailments of ammonia production in Europe due to high gas prices. This led the company's European gas consumption to fall more than 7% YoY in 3Q26. This trend is expected across European industry, especially with gas prices even higher now.

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